

Colin Brown

POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW · UBC LINGUISTICS

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Academic Employment

University of British Columbia, Department of Linguistics

Vancouver, BC

SSHRC POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW

2024–Present

- Supervisor: Henry Davis

Education

University of California, Los Angeles

Los Angeles, CA

PHD LINGUISTICS

2024

- PhD Dissertation: The form and function of interrogatives in Sm'algyax
- Committee: Yael Sharvit, Harold Torrence (co-chairs), Ethan Poole, Lisa Matthewson (UBC)

McGill University

Montreal, QC

MA LINGUISTICS

2016

- MA Thesis: Extraction restrictions in Gitksan
- Committee: Jessica Coon, Lisa Travis

University of British Columbia

Vancouver, BC

BA LINGUISTICS

2013

- Capstone projects: Semantics of Gitksan clefts; Sluicing in Wolof

Publications

* peer reviewed

PUBLISHED

***Colin Brown**. Bipartite question formation in Sm'algyax. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 11(1).

doi: <https://doi.org/10.16995/glossa.20160>

***Colin Brown**, Harold Torrence. 2025. On the clausal syntax of Dschang predicate focus doubling. In Akinbiyi Akinlabi, Sampson Korsah, Sharon Rose & Abdul-Razak Sulemana (eds.), *Cross-disciplinary approaches to Information Structure in Niger-Congo languages*, 215–243. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.16875466

Colin Brown. 2025. Clause typing and clitic linearization in Gitksan. In *Papers for the 60th International Conference of Salish and Neighbouring Languages*. UBCWPL.

Colin Brown, Henry Davis. 2024. A second-last position clitic in Sm'algyax (Coast Tsimshian). *Proceedings from the 54th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS 54)*. University of Massachusetts GLSA.

Colin Brown, Henry Davis. 2024. A second-last position clitic in Sm'algyax: the puzzle. *The title of this volume is shorter than its contributions are allowed to be: Papers in honour of Hotze Rullmann*. Vancouver, BC: UBC Occasional Papers in Linguistics, Volume 9.

Henry Davis, **Colin Brown**. 2024. A second-last position clitic in Sm'algyax: a solution. *The title of this volume is shorter than its contributions are allowed to be: Papers in honour of Hotze Rullmann*. Vancouver, BC: UBC Occasional Papers in Linguistics, Volume 9.

***Colin Brown**. 2024. Questions and their relatives in Sm'algyax. *The International Journal of American Linguistics*. vol. 90, no. 3.

***Colin Brown**. 2024. Conjectural questions in Sm'algyax. *Folia Linguistica*. <https://doi.org/10.1515/flin-2023-2051>

***Colin Brown**. 2023. Irrealis-marked interrogatives as negative rhetorical questions. vol. 9, no. 1. *Open Linguistics*.

- Colin Brown**, Clarissa Forbes, Michael Schwan. 2020. Clause-type, transitivity, and the transitive vowel in Tsimshianic. In Papers for the 55th International Conference of Salish and Neighbouring Languages. UBCWPL.
- Colin Brown**. 2017. Syntactic ergativity in Gitksan. Proceedings from the 21st annual Workshop on the Constituency of Languages of the Americas. UBCWPL.

TO APPEAR

- Colin Brown**, Starr Sandoval. *Wh*-infinitives as topic-setting questions. Proceedings from the 56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS 56). University of Massachusetts GLSA.
- Colin Brown**, Harold Torrence. Predicate focus in Dschang. Proceedings from the 10th World Congress of African Linguistics
- Noah Elkins, **Colin Brown**. Free relative clauses in Mam. Proceedings from the annual Workshop on the Constituency of Languages of the Americas. UBCWPL.
- Colin Brown**. Polar questions in Sm'algyax. Proceedings from the annual Workshop on the Constituency of Languages of the Americas. UBCWPL.

UNDER REVIEW

- Colin Brown**, Henry Davis. Tritropic clitics in Tsimshianic.
- Colin Brown**. An inversion account of pied-piping with inversion in Sm'algyax.
- Noah Elkins, Harold Torrence, **Colin Brown**. *Wh*-movement paths and oblique extraction in Mam (Mayan).

IN PREP

- Colin Brown**. Local and long-distance *wh*-paths in Sm'algyax. (Manuscript.)
- Colin Brown**. Correlates of clausal complementation in Gitksan. (Manuscript.)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Colin Brown**. 2024. The form and function of interrogatives in Sm'algyax. Doctoral Dissertation. UCLA.
- Colin Brown**. 2020. Illocutionary mood marking in Sm'algyax. Qualifying Paper. UCLA.
- Colin Brown**. 2016. Extraction restrictions in Gitksan. Master's Thesis. McGill University.

Presentations

INVITED TALKS

- April 10, 2026. *Wh*-movement, *wh*-predication, and *pied-piping with inversion*. UBC Linguistics Colloquium. Vancouver, BC.
- May 1, 2025. *Clause typing and clitic linearization in Gitksan*. Simon Fraser University Indigenous Languages Colloquium. Burnaby, BC.
- March 3, 2025. *Clitic linearization and morphology*. Guest lecture: Clitics: a View from the Pacific Northwest (Prof. Henry Davis) University of British Columbia. Vancouver, BC.
- November 28, 2022. *Interrogative particles in Sm'algyax*. Guest lecture: Advanced Syntax I (Prof. Neda Todorovic) University of Toronto. Toronto, ON.
- April 1, 2022. *Variable interrogative flip in Sm'algyax evidential questions*. Invited talk: UC Berkeley Syntax and Semantics Circle. Berkeley, CA.

PRESENTATIONS

- Henry Davis, Yurika Aonuki, **Colin Brown**, Una Chow, Clarissa Forbes, Lisa Matthewson, Michael David Schwan. 2026. An Interior Tsimshianic Perspective on Variation. Methods in Dialectology and Language Diversity XIX. University of British Columbia. Vancouver, BC. August 4-7.
- Henry Davis, **Colin Brown**. 2026. *Wh*-questions and focus in predicate-initial languages: evidence from Tsimshianic. Semantics of Under-represented Languages in the Americas (SULA) and Semantics of Languages of Africa, Asia, Australia and Oceania (TripleA) 2026. University of British Columbia. Vancouver, BC. May 12-15.

- Colin Brown.** 2026. Pied-piping with inversion involves inversion. West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 44. Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México. Mexico City, Mexico. May 6–7.
- Colin Brown, Starr Sandoval.** 2025. What to do about *what to do*? Root *wh*-infinitives as deliberative non-canonical questions. North East Linguistics Society (NELS) 56. New York University. New York, NY. October 17–19. (Poster presentation)
- Colin Brown.** 2024. Epistemic *la* in Mam: linearization and meaning contribution. Form and Analysis in Mayan Linguistics (FAMLi) 7. Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México. Mexico City, Mexico. February 22–23.
- Colin Brown, Henry Davis.** 2024. A second-last position clitic in Sm'algyax. North East Linguistics Society (NELS) 54. Massachusetts Institute of Technology. Cambridge, MA. January 26–27.
- Colin Brown.** 2023. Polar questions in Sm'algyax. The Workshop on Structure and Constituency in Languages of the Americas 2023. McGill University. Montréal, QC. April 28–30.
- Noah Elkins, **Colin Brown.** 2023. Headless relative clauses in Mam. The Workshop on Structure and Constituency in Languages of the Americas 2023. McGill University. Montréal, QC. April 28–30.
- Colin Brown.** 2022. Irrealis-marked interrogatives as negative rhetorical questions. Subjectivity and Intersubjectivity in Language and Culture. Workshop “Non-canonical interrogatives across languages: prosody, semantics, pragmatics”, Tartu, Estonia. May 12–13.
- Colin Brown.** 2022. Rhetorical questions two ways. California Universities Semantics and Pragmatics, University of California, Los Angeles. May 6.
- Colin Brown.** 2022. Information-seeking and non-information-seeking questions with conjectural evidentials. UBC Gitksan Lab: UBC Linguistics, Vancouver, BC. April 11.
- Colin Brown, Zhuo Chen, Matthew Czuba, Blake Lehman, Harold Torrence.** 2022. The Inventory of Polar Question Types in Dschang. The Annual Conference on African Linguistics 53. University of California, San Diego. April 7–9.
- Colin Brown.** 2021. Variable interrogative flip in evidential questions in Sm'algyax. Workshop on The Pragmatics of Evidentiality. Venice, Italy. June 19–21.
- Colin Brown, Harold Torrence.** 2021. Analyzing predicate focus doubling in Dschang. 10th World Congress of African Linguistics. University of Leiden. June 7–12.
- Colin Brown, Harold Torrence.** 2021. The syntax of predicate focus doubling in Dschang. Annual Conference of African Linguistics 51–52. University of Florida. April 8–10.
- Colin Brown, Harold Torrence.** 2021. Predicate Focus Doubling in Dschang: Implications for Clausal Syntax. Linguistics Society of America 2021. Held virtually. January 7–10.
- Colin Brown.** 2020. Interrogative mood marking in Sm'algyax. Linguistics Society of America 2020. New Orleans, LA. January 2–5.
- Colin Brown.** 2019. Interrogatives at the interface: Sentential mood marking in Sm'algyax. California Universities Semantics and Pragmatics 2019. University of Southern California. November 9–10.
- Colin Brown, Clarissa Forbes.** 2018. Three (hidden) obliques in Gitksan. The Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas 2018. Salt Lake City, UT. January 4–7.
- Colin Brown.** 2016. Revisiting ergativity in Gitksan. The Workshop on Structure and Constituency in Languages of the Americas 2016. UQAM. Montréal, QC. April 1–3.
- Colin Brown.** 2016. A structural account of split ergativity in Gitksan. Putting Fieldwork on Indigenous Languages to New Uses. Campinas, Brazil. March 21–April 2. (Poster presentation)
- Colin Brown.** 2016. Absolutive in Tsimshianic. The Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas 2016. Washington, DC. January 7–10.
- Henry Davis, **Colin Brown.** 2014. Focus and Negative Ellipsis in Gitksan. International Conference on Salish and Neighbouring Languages 48. Coeur d'Alene, Idaho. August 2–3.
- Colin Brown.** 2014. Towards a unified semantics of clefts and determiners in Tlingit. Semantics of Under-represented Languages of the Americas 8. UBC. Vancouver, BC. May 16–18. (Poster presentation)
- Colin Brown.** 2014. Clefts without Presuppositions? Some evidence from Gitksan. Semantics of Under-represented Languages of the Americas 8. UBC. Vancouver, BC. May 16–18.

Teaching/Academic Experience _____

AS INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD

- 2026 **FNST220-3: Introduction to Linguistics**, Wilp Wilxo'oskwhl Nisga'a Institute/UNBC; Summer
- 2023 **LING120C: Semantics I**, UCLA Linguistics; Summer
- 2022 **LING120B: Syntax I**, UCLA Linguistics; Summer
- 2021 **LING120C: Semantics I**, UCLA Linguistics; Summer
- 2020 **LING160: Field Methods (Cotaught with Blake Lehman)**, UCLA Linguistics; Summer
- 2018 **FNST320-3: The Structure of a First Nations Language (Nisga'a; Tsimshianic)**, Wilp Wilxo'oskwhl Nisga'a Institute/UNBC; Summer
- 2018 **FNST220-3: Introduction to Linguistics**, Wilp Wilxo'oskwhl Nisga'a Institute/UNBC; Summer
- 2018 **EDEE 223: Language Arts**, Listuguj/McGill B.Ed Program; Summer
- 2016 **FNST220-3: Introduction to Linguistics**, Wilp Wilxo'oskwhl Nisga'a Institute/UNBC; Winter

AS TEACHING ASSISTANT

- 2024 **LING1: Introduction to Study of Language (Instructor: Guiseppina Silvestri)**, UCLA Linguistics, Spring
- 2024 **LING1: Introduction to Study of Language (Instructor: Guiseppina Silvestri)**, UCLA Linguistics, Winter
- 2022 **LING120C: Semantics I (Instructor: Yael Sharvit)**, UCLA Linguistics, Winter
- 2021 **LING120B: Syntax I (Instructor: Nicoletta Loccioni)**, UCLA Linguistics, Winter
- 2020 **LING127C: Linguistic Typology and Universals (Instructor: Hilda Koopman)**, UCLA Linguistics, Winter
- 2020 **LING127C: Linguistic Typology and Universals (Instructor: Anoop Mahajan)**, UCLA Linguistics, Fall
- 2019 **LING20: Introduction to Linguistic Theory (Instructor: Guiseppina Silvestri)**, UCLA Linguistics, Fall
- 2019 **LING20: Introduction to Linguistic Theory (Instructor: Thomas Motter)**, UCLA Linguistics, Summer
- 2016 **LING200: Introduction to Linguistics (Instructor: Hadas Koteck)**, McGill Linguistics, Spring
- 2016 **LING200: Introduction to Linguistics (Instructor: Meagan Fowlie)**, McGill Linguistics, Fall

OTHER

- 2023 **Research Assistant: Speech Errors Corpus Website**, UCLA Linguistics
- 2021 **Workshop Co-organizer: Sm'algyax Grammar Workshop (with Margaret Anderson and Mique'l Dangel)**, Juneau, Alaska. June 7-18
- 2018 **Workshop Organizer: Grammar, writing, and academic success. Listuguj/McGill B.Ed Program**, Listuguj, QC. March 20-23.
- 2016-2017 **Research Assistant: McGill Ergativity Lab**, McGill Linguistics
- 2013 **Research Assistant: Gitksan Research Lab**, UBC Linguistics

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants _____

2024-2026	Postdoctoral Fellowship , Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council	\$ 140,000 CAD
2024	Jacobs Research Funds , Whatcom Museum/University of Washington Libraries	\$ 3000 USD
2023	Ladefoged Scholarship , UCLA	\$ 1,500 USD
2022-2023	Dissertation Year Fellowship , UCLA	\$ 37,000 USD
2022-2023	Harry and Yvonne Lenart Graduate Travel Fellowship , UCLA	\$ 8,000 USD
2022	Ladefoged Scholarship , UCLA	\$ 1,500 USD
2019	Canadian Studies Award , UCLA	\$ 1,000 USD
2018-2022	Doctoral Fellowship , Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council	\$ 80,000 CAD
2018-2021	Joseph-Armand Bombardier Canada Graduate Scholarships-Doctoral , Declined for SSHRC above	\$ 105,000 CAD
2018-2022	Andrew W. Mellon Fellowship , UCLA	\$ 34,000 USD
2018-2019	Graduate Dean Scholar's Award , UCLA	\$ 14,500 USD
2015	Joseph-Armand Bombardier Canada Graduate Scholarships-Master's , Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council	\$ 17,500 CAD
2014	Grad Excellence Award in Linguistics , McGill University	\$ 7,000 CAD
2010	Leon Fus Memorial Prize , UBC	\$ 700 CAD

Outreach & Professional Development

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2026-2027	SSHRC Canada Graduate Research Scholarship – Doctoral program , Committee Member
2026	Semantics and Pragmatics , Editorial Board
2025-2026	SSHRC Canada Graduate Research Scholarship – Doctoral program , Committee Member
2022	Fieldwork Job Search Committee UCLA Linguistics Department , Committee Member
2020-2021	UCLA Graduate Linguistics Council , President

PEER REVIEW

Semantics and Pragmatics

Oxford University Press

Canadian Journal of Linguistics/Revue canadienne de linguistique

Language Science Press

The Annual Conference on African Linguistics

Languages

English — Native

French — Intermediate

Spanish — Intermediate

Polish — Intermediate

Sm'algyax — Research

Gitksan — Research

Mam — Research

Dschang — Research

References

Prof. Henry Davis; UBC linguistics: henry.davis@ubc.ca

Prof. Yael Sharvit; UCLA linguistics: ysharvit@humnet.ucla.edu

Prof. Harold Torrence; UCLA linguistics: htorrence@humnet.ucla.edu